TalentMine / TalentHunt

Local Setup & Execution Guide — Candidate Intelligence Platform

ARCHITECTURE SUMMARY

TalentMine is structured as a decoupled application: a high-performance **Modular Frontend** (HTML5, Vanilla CSS layers, and ES6 JavaScript) paired with a **PHP REST API Backend** with JSON data stores for candidate mining, validation, and exports.

1. System Prerequisites

PHP 8.x (Installed & in PATH)

Serves the backend REST endpoints and executes local servers. Verify via: `php -v`.

Modern Web Browser

Google Chrome, Microsoft Edge, Firefox, or Brave with JavaScript and Canvas enabled.

2. Method 1: Using Built-in PHP Development Server (Recommended & Fastest)

The built-in PHP server is the cleanest method to run the entire frontend and backend locally with zero extra software.

1 Open Terminal / PowerShell in the Project Directory

Open your command line and navigate to the project directory:

```
cd C:\Users\ibrah\code\etc\TalentMine
```

2 Start the PHP Server on Port 8000

Execute the following command in PowerShell / Terminal:

```
php -S 127.0.0.1:8000
```

Keep this terminal window open while using the app. Press `Ctrl + C` whenever you wish to stop the server.

3 Open Google Chrome and Navigate to the Localhost URL

Open Google Chrome and enter the following address in your URL bar:

```
http://127.0.0.1:8000
```

The root automatically redirects into `frontend/index.html` and connects to the live PHP backend (`/backend/api/candidates.php`).

3. Method 2: Running with XAMPP (Apache + PHP)

If you prefer a full graphical environment using the XAMPP Control Panel, follow these steps:

1 Install & Open XAMPP

Download and install XAMPP from `apachefriends.org`. Open the **XAMPP Control Panel**.

2 Copy the Project Folder to `htdocs`

Place this repository into your XAMPP web directory:

```
C:\xampp\htdocs\TalentMine
```

3 Start Apache & Navigate in Chrome

Click **Start** next to Apache in the XAMPP Control Panel, then navigate to:

```
http://localhost/TalentMine
```

Direct URL: `http://localhost/TalentMine/frontend/index.html`

4. Verifying Local Application Functionality

Feature	Action to Test	Expected Behavior
Live Network Hero	View the top hero section	3D canvas particle simulation renders with active node count.
Backend API Link	Check badge in Mining Setup	Displays `PHP BACKEND CONNECTED` in green.
Data Mining Engine	Select filters & click *Generate*	Pipeline animation runs link checks & loads candidate records.
Candidate Modal	Click candidate name in table	Modal opens with skills, email, phone, and shortlist toggle.
Dataset Export	Go to Export tab & click *Download CSV*	Generates and downloads a clean, verified CSV spreadsheet.

5. Troubleshooting Common Issues

Port 8000 is occupied

Bind to port 8080 instead: `php -S 127.0.0.1:8080`, then visit `http://127.0.0.1:8080`.

'php' is not recognized in terminal

Add your PHP folder (e.g. `C:\xampp\php`) to your Windows Environment Variables under **System PATH**.